

Mercedes S. Fagan

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<https://www.linkedin.com/in/mercedes-fagan/>

EDUCATION

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- Juris Doctorate, Vermont Law School**, South Royalton, VT **May 2023**
- GPA: 3.5; Top 30% of Class; Dean's List
 - Student Ambassador; Black Law Student Association (Parliamentarian, 2021-2022); Teaching Assistant (Corporations and Civil Procedure, 2022-2023)
- Bachelor of Science, Political Science, Western Carolina University**, Cullowhee, NC **May 2020**
- GPA: 3.8; Top 10% of Class; Summa Cum Laude
 - Member of Delta Sigma Theta, Inc.

EXPERIENCE

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- Managing Attorney - TrustWorks** **June 2024 – Present**
- Oversee all aspects of office operations, including strategic planning, budgeting, and staffing, ensuring alignment with the firm's vision
 - Handle a high volume of consultations with 30-40 new clients per month, with 75% client conversion rate
 - Draft comprehensive and complex estate plans, including Irrevocable Trusts, Qualified Income (Miller) Trusts, and Special Needs Trusts, while also preparing wills, powers of attorney, and advising clients on tax implications and asset protection strategies
 - Handle matters from inception to conclusion, including meeting with clients, developing a strategy for an estate plan, drafting and overseeing estate planning documents
 - Provide prospective clients with live seminar on information and Estate Planning and Probate
- Associate Attorney - Smith, Welch, Webb and White, LLC** **August 2023 – June 2024**
- Zealously advocated for clients in the following areas: *Corporate Transactions, Probate and Estate Matters, Civil Litigation, Personal Injury, Zoning & Local Government*
 - Advised on corporate transactions, contract negotiations, procurement policies, and intergovernmental agreements
 - Drafted and reviewed intergovernmental agreements, code of ordinances, professional service agreements, IT and SaaS contracts, and corporate governance documents
 - Conducted legal research and analysis on government contracting, vendor disputes, and procurement-related litigation
 - Assisted in due diligence for mergers, acquisitions, and securities transactions
 - Appeared in court for hearings, trials, and other proceedings, presenting evidence and arguments effectively to advocate for clients
 - Engaged in settlement negotiations on behalf of clients, striving for favorable outcomes while minimizing litigation costs and time
- Judicial Clerk - Henry County Superior Court** **January 2023 – May 2023**
- Drafted judicial orders, sentencing guides, bench briefs, and official court correspondence with careful attention to accuracy and compliance requirements
 - Conducted extensive legal research and analysis on statutes, regulations, and rulings impacting civil, domestic, and governmental matters
 - Prepared legal memoranda on public sector procurement, government regulations, and compliance frameworks to support judicial decision-making
- Student Attorney - South Royalton Legal Clinic: Veterans Legal Assistance Project of Vermont** **August 2022 – December 2022**
- Provided advocacy and developed cases for veterans on diverse civil and veteran-specific matters including bankruptcy, employment law, landlord-tenant law, VA benefit appeals, and discharge upgrades
 - Conducted legal research and drafted legal memorandums, contracts, estate planning documents, and other transactional documents
 - Assisted in the preparation and filing of appeals before administrative agencies
- Contract Specialist - Crown Castle** **May 2022 – August 2022**
- Executed over 100 contracts with less than 5% error and gained pass through achievements
 - Developed contracts and associated documents per company standards and customer expectations
 - Reviewed and analyzed financial disclosure, shareholder agreements, and risk management provisions to ensure compliance with government and corporate standards
 - Partnered with business teams to communicate processes and troubleshoot problems with execution
- Student Clinician - Vermont Small Business Development Center** **August 2021 – May 2023**
- Combined business and legal expertise to advise and create innovative custom solutions to meet small business owners' objectives (contracts, entity formation, intellectual property, business risk analysis, etc.)
 - Drafted business briefs and reports to share widely with SBDC clients about ranging topics
 - Advised small business owners on business structuring, regulatory compliance, procurement regulations, and securities law
 - Delivered a Continuing Legal Education (CLE) course for the Vermont Bar Association on business law and small businesses in Vermont
- Paralegal - Nicola Cummings Law Firm** **May 2019 – August 2021**
- Corresponded with clients regarding the status of their cases and other details
 - Conducted legal research, investigations, and statistical and documentary research
 - Drafted criminal and personal injury legal documents, correspondence, and pleadings

SKILLS

Technical Proficiency: Microsoft Office Suite, Westlaw, LexisNexis, WealthCounsel, ElderCounsel, Salesforce, SaaS Platforms, MyCase, Clio, DocuSign, HotDocs, PeachCourt, Odyssey File, Caret Legal, Worldox, NetDocs | **Credentials:** Licensed Georgia Attorney, Georgia Notary Public